

Centre unveils ₹10 billion fund for space tech startups

The Union Cabinet has greenlit a ₹10 billion venture capital fund to support space tech startups through the IN-SPACe programme. The fund, operational for five years, will invest ₹1.5 billion-2.5 billion annually, targeting 40 startups with equity investments between ₹100 million and ₹600 million. It aims to boost India's space sector, foster innovation, and generate jobs.



Representational image

Karnataka launches accelerator network for tech startups

The Karnataka government has launched two initiatives, Elevate 2024 and the Karnataka Accelerator Network (KAN), offering grants of up to ₹5 million for startups. These programmes provide incubation, mentorship, and

connections to venture capital, focusing on emerging technologies like AI, IoT, and blockchain. The initiatives aim to boost the state's startup ecosystem and economic growth.

West Bengal plans tax incentives for tech firms

West Bengal is set to introduce policies to attract tech companies, including incentives such as tax exemptions, focusing on global capability centres (GCCs) and the semiconductor sector. This follows the launch of India's

first national security semiconductor plant in Kolkata. These initiatives are centred around the ongoing 250-acre Bengal Silicon Valley Tech Hub, set to generate 100,000 jobs by 2025.

PEOPLE (on the move)



Applied Materials welcomes Avinash Avula to lead Indian operations

Avinash Avula will now lead Applied Materials as the Country President for India, overseeing operations across five locations. With leadership experience at Applied and DuPont, Avula will drive growth in India's semiconductor market, focusing on R&D,

product development, and operations. He previously played a crucial role in expanding Applied's footprint in Singapore.

Xiaomi India President Muralikrishnan B steps down

Muralikrishnan B, President of Xiaomi India, has resigned after six years to pursue an Executive Doctorate in management, focusing on consumer behaviour. He will remain an advisor. Muralikrishnan joined in 2018 and held various roles, including Chief Operating Officer, before being promoted to President in 2022. Under his leadership, despite challenges like the ED investigation, Xiaomi strengthened its presence in the Indian consumer market.



Tata's Croma names Shibashish Roy as new CEO



Tata's Infiniti Retail has appointed Shibashish Roy as CEO of Croma, succeeding Avijit Mitra. Roy, currently Deputy CEO, brings expertise in omnichannel strategy and operations. He aims to drive Croma's growth in the competitive electronics sector. Mitra, retiring in March 2025, will remain on the board, ensuring a smooth leadership transition.

Ramachandra Puttanna joins Greaves Retail to lead EV ventures

Greaves Cotton has appointed Ramachandra Puttanna as the new EV Business Head. With over 35 years of experience at companies like BOSCH and ZF Group, Puttanna will lead Greaves' electric vehicle components and new business initiatives. He holds a mechanical engineering degree and advanced management qualifications from IIM Bangalore.

